**LUWIRE'S WILDLIFE MONITORING CAMERA TRAP PROJECT**

**LUWIRE** – *Lugenda Wildlife Reserve*, is a 4,500km² private concession nested in Mozambique's Niassa Special Reserve. Home to internationally important populations of leopard, lion, wild dog, and elephant, this constitutes one of Africa's last pristine wildernesses.

Understanding the population sizes of key species within the concession is a top priority for Luwire. Wildlife monitoring is essential for keeping track of animal movement patterns, habitat utilisation, population demographics, snaring and poaching incidents and breakouts. This also provides the data needed to set hunting regulations and determine if other wildlife management practices are needed to conserve a wildlife species.

Camera traps is one of the fastest developing and most widely used technology in wildlife monitoring and conservation. They are a key tool to help detect cryptic wildlife and assist to obtain first-hand images or video data in the field, providing abundant information for understanding the individual, population, community, behaviour and habitat of wildlife. One of the benefits of camera trapping is that they help to understand how humans and wildlife interact with each other. However, camera traps are not without problems; the often large amounts of data generated by these devices can overwhelm users and lead to problems with storage, backup, sharing and image processing.



*Yasalde Feliciano Massinge – Camera Trap Project Lead*



*Camera trap installed on a miombo tree at Luwire in block L7*

The camera trap project is led by Yasalde Massingue, a young Mozambican academic with a degree in Biological Sciences and currently finalising a master's degree in Applied Ecology by Unilurio's Faculty of Natural Sciences. Yasalde is also Luwire's SMART Technician and contributes hugely to data analysis and reporting pertinent to Luwire's law enforcement efforts across the concession.

In close collaboration with the Niassa Carnivore Project, Luwire contribute to the wider wildlife count and data analysis by ensuring frequent and carefully coordinated installation of camera trap grids which are set on foot, due to the lack of road infrastructure in the reserve. These grids allow Luwire to establish rough numbers for monitoring population species such as leopard and wild dog and give us a baseline for future comparisons.

This project aims to enhance Luwire's evidence-based conservation efforts by informing practical conservation decisions to further help the wildlife of Niassa Special Reserve.

*For further details kindly visit www.luwire.org or contact Yasalde Massingue at Yasalde.massingue@luwire.org*





